The CareLeaders Learning

Course brochure

Schools

Tools for Schools

Read the behaviour, then reach for the right tool.

A practical twilight session for school staff on reading the messages in children's behaviour and responding with the right tools. One child's story, the theory underneath it, and tools staff use the next day. Also available as a keynote.



Length
A twilight, a full day or a keynote

How
Face to face or workshop or keynote

Group
A whole staff team for the twilight.
Any size as a keynote

For
Schools

The problem it solves

Behaviour from children in care is often read as defiance and met with sanctions that escalate it. Staff want something practical they can use tomorrow, and many are unsure how social care works or who to call.

Helps with

- Trauma-informed practice
- School attendance and attainment
- Behaviour, incidents and restraint



What is different after the course.

For your staff

- Read behaviour as communication, not defiance, and respond in the moment
- Try one of three practical tools in the week after the session
- Talk about children in care differently in the staffroom and in records
- Understand the social care side and know who to call

For children

- Fewer escalations and sanctions in school
- Key adults in school who understand why the day can be hard
- Staff who talk about them without labels or low expectations
- School and social care working with each other, not against each other

What they learn

The knowledge and the tools.

- How to read behaviour as communication and respond in the moment
- What attachment and trauma look like in school
- How language and stigma shape a child's school life
- Where school and social care clash, and what to do about it
- Three practical tools to use the next day

Who it is for

- Teachers and teaching assistants
- Pastoral and safeguarding staff
- Designated teachers for children in care
- Senior leaders setting the behaviour policy

Session by session

How the course runs.

Story Theory Action

1 The messages in behaviour

Behaviour as communication, through one child's story and what the adults around him missed. What sits behind the behaviour you see, and the window of tolerance.

You leave with The window of tolerance, as a way to read what sits behind behaviour

2 Attachment and trauma

Why some children find school so hard. Attachment and trauma, and what they look like in a classroom, a corridor and a detention, and the part key adults play.

You leave with A clearer picture of the key adult's role in the school day

3 Language and stigma

How language in staffrooms, meetings and reports shapes how a child is seen and treated, and how stigma and low expectations take hold.

You leave with Ways to change the conversation about a child in the staffroom

4 Where school and social care clash

Why the two systems frustrate each other, who the designated teacher really is, and what to do about it.

You leave with Three tools to take into school, with the handouts to keep

Choose how you run it

Formats.

Face to face

We come to you: development days, twilights and team days, in your building or a venue you choose.

Length	A three-hour twilight, or a development day with practice time
Group	A whole staff team
You provide	A room, a screen and the time protected

Workshop or keynote

A shorter, high-energy version for conferences, staff briefings and board sessions.

Length	Up to 90 minutes
Group	Any size
You provide	The slot in your event, a screen and a microphone



Included: Three tools to use the next day, with the handouts to keep

Delivered Run as a workshop at Liverpool Virtual School's Rising Futures conference in June 2025, for headteachers, designated teachers and social workers.

Questions commissioners ask

What will staff actually take away?

Three tools to use the next day, with handouts, and a one-page summary for staff who could not attend. At Liverpool Virtual School's conference the tools included profile reframing, de-escalation and separating the reason from the behaviour.

What do we need to do as a school?

Release the staff team for three hours after school and bring real, anonymised examples. Afterwards, staff try one tool in the following week and tell us what happened, so the next session builds on it.

How long is it?

Three hours as a twilight session. Up to 90 minutes as a keynote.

Is it just for designated teachers?

No. It is for the whole staff team. Designated teachers who want a year-long programme should look at the Designated Leaders Programme.

Can you run it for a trust or a virtual school?

Yes, as a keynote at a conference or as twilight sessions across schools.

Is it CPD certified?

Participants receive a certificate of completion from us for CPD purposes.

Can you shape it around our service?

Yes. We tailor the examples, the length and the mix of people in the room to your service, your procedures and the children you work with.

Who delivers it?

People with lived experience of care and professional experience of children's services. Every course is designed by Luke Rodgers BEM and follows the same Story, Theory, Action approach.



Luke Rodgers BEM
Founder and CEO, The Care Leaders

Who designs and delivers it

From care leaver to care leader.

Luke went into care at 10. At 15 he was living in a bed and breakfast, and at 18 in a caravan. He gave his first keynote at 19, and has spent his career since inside children's services as a consultant, trainer, speaker and national engagement lead.

He set up The Care Leaders to go from care leaver to care leader, and to help others make the same move. He led the national engagement on England's new fostering standards, was a Knowledge Equity Fellow at Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, and was awarded the British Empire Medal in 2018.

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- **Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award**
  iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026
- **British Empire Medal**
  2018, for commitment to children and families
- **Knowledge Equity Fellow**
  Saïd Business School, University of Oxford
- **45+ keynotes since 2024**
  From team days to national conferences

The CareLeaders Learning

Getting started

Bring Tools for Schools to your team.

1 **Get in touch**
Tell us who it is for and roughly how many people.

2 **Have a call**
We talk through your service, your people and your dates.

3 **Get a clear quote**
We quote per cohort, based on numbers, format and how much tailoring you want.

4 **We run it**
Shaped around your service, your procedures and the children you work with.

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Often booked with

Schools
The Designated Leaders Programme
A year that turns designated teachers into leaders of trauma-informed practice in their school.

Understanding care
Behind the Behaviour
Reading behaviour as communication, and responding without losing the relationship.

Schools
Two Timetables: When School Meets Social Care
Teachers and social workers learning each other's worlds, so children stop falling between them.

iese Awards GOLD Winner 2026 The Public Sector Transformation Awards

Children & Young People Now Awards 2023 Winner

Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award, iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026.
Children & Young People Now Workforce Development Award 2023.